

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

End-to-End Sales Process

Sales Department

|                |                          |
|----------------|--------------------------|
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## Table of Contents

### **1. Purpose**

### **2. Scope**

### **3. Roles & Responsibilities**

### **4. Definitions & Abbreviations**

### **5. Procedure**

#### *5.1 Lead Generation*

#### *5.2 Lead Qualification*

#### *5.3 Discovery & Needs Analysis*

#### *5.4 Proposal & Negotiation*

#### *5.5 Closing*

#### *5.6 Order Processing & Handover*

#### *5.7 Post-Sale Account Management*

### **6. Records & Documentation Maintained**

### **7. Related Documents / References**

### **8. Revision History**

## 1. Purpose

This SOP outlines the standard process for managing the complete sales lifecycle — from lead generation and qualification through to deal closure, order processing, and post-sale account management. It ensures a consistent, professional, and trackable approach across the sales team.

## 2. Scope

This procedure applies to all sales team members involved in generating, qualifying, and converting leads into paying customers, as well as managing accounts after the sale, regardless of product line or customer segment.

## 3. Roles & Responsibilities

| Role                             | Responsibility                                                                               |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Sales Representative / Executive | Prospects leads, conducts discovery calls, prepares proposals, negotiates, and closes deals. |
| Sales Manager                    | Approves pricing/discounts beyond standard limits, reviews pipeline, and coaches the team.   |
| Pre-Sales / Solutions Team       | Supports technical scoping, demos, and proposal customization for complex deals.             |
| Marketing                        | Supplies qualified leads (MQLs) and campaign collateral to support the sales process.        |
| Finance / Billing                | Validates pricing, processes invoices, and confirms payment terms.                           |
| Customer Success / Delivery      | Receives handover post-close and manages onboarding and account servicing.                   |

## 4. Definitions & Abbreviations

| Term                     | Definition                                                                                      |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Lead                     | A person or organization that has shown potential interest in the company's product or service. |
| MQL                      | Marketing Qualified Lead — a lead assessed by Marketing as ready for sales engagement.          |
| SQL                      | Sales Qualified Lead — a lead vetted by Sales as having genuine buying intent and fit.          |
| CRM                      | Customer Relationship Management system used to track leads, opportunities, and accounts.       |
| Proposal/Quotation       | Formal document outlining pricing, scope, and terms presented to a prospect.                    |
| Closed-Won / Closed-Lost | CRM status indicating a deal has been won or lost.                                              |

## 5. Procedure

### 5.1 Lead Generation

**Step 1 — Capture Leads:** Leads are captured from inbound channels (website, campaigns, referrals) and outbound prospecting (cold calling, LinkedIn outreach, events) and logged into the CRM.

**Step 2 — Assign Ownership:** Sales Manager assigns each new lead to a Sales Representative based on territory, product line, or account size.

### 5.2 Lead Qualification

**Step 3 — Initial Outreach:** Sales Representative contacts the lead within the defined SLA (e.g., 24 hours) to gauge interest.

**Step 4 — Qualify the Lead:** Representative applies a qualification framework (e.g., BANT — Budget, Authority, Need, Timeline) to determine if the lead is a genuine SQL.

**Step 5 — Update CRM Stage:** Qualified leads are moved to the 'Opportunity' stage in the CRM; disqualified leads are marked with a reason and nurtured by Marketing.

### 5.3 Discovery & Needs Analysis

**Step 6 — Discovery Call:** Representative conducts a structured call to understand the prospect's business challenges, requirements, budget, and decision timeline.

**Step 7 — Solution Mapping:** Representative, with Pre-Sales support if needed, maps the prospect's needs to relevant products or services.

**Step 8 — Demo / Presentation:** Representative or Pre-Sales team delivers a tailored product demo or capability presentation to the prospect.

### 5.4 Proposal & Negotiation

**Step 9 — Prepare Proposal:** Representative drafts a formal proposal or quotation covering scope, pricing, timelines, and terms, using approved templates.

**Step 10 — Internal Approval:** Any pricing or discount beyond standard authority limits is routed to the Sales Manager for approval before sending.

**Step 11 — Send Proposal:** Proposal is shared with the prospect and logged in the CRM with the date and version.

**Step 12 — Handle Objections & Negotiate:** Representative addresses objections, negotiates terms, and revises the proposal as needed while staying within approved pricing bands.

### 5.5 Closing

**Step 13 — Verbal Commitment:** Prospect confirms intent to proceed; Representative updates the CRM opportunity stage to 'Verbal Commit'.

**Step 14 — Contract / PO Execution:** Representative coordinates with the prospect and internal legal/finance teams to finalize the contract or purchase order.

**Step 15 — Mark Closed-Won:** Once signed, the deal is marked 'Closed-Won' in the CRM with final deal value and key terms recorded.

### 5.6 Order Processing & Handover

**Step 16 — Process the Order:** Sales Representative submits the order details to Finance/Operations for invoicing and fulfillment setup.

**Step 17 — Internal Handover:** Representative conducts a formal handover call with the Customer Success/Delivery team, sharing account context, commitments made, and key contacts.

**Step 18 — Confirm Kickoff:** Customer Success schedules the onboarding kickoff with the customer within the agreed timeframe.

### 5.7 Post-Sale Account Management

**Step 19 — Relationship Check-Ins:** Representative or Account Manager conducts periodic check-ins to ensure customer satisfaction and identify upsell/cross-sell opportunities.

**Step 20 — Renewal Tracking:** For subscription/contract-based sales, the renewal date is tracked in the CRM and outreach initiated ahead of expiry.

**Step 21 — Pipeline & Forecast Reporting:** Representative maintains accurate CRM records; Sales Manager reviews pipeline health and forecast accuracy in weekly review meetings.

6. Records & Documentation Maintained

- CRM lead and opportunity records
- Discovery call notes
- Proposals and quotations issued
- Approved pricing/discount exceptions
- Signed contracts / purchase orders
- Handover notes to Customer Success
- Sales pipeline and forecast reports

7. Related Documents / References

- Sales Commission Policy
- Discount & Approval Matrix
- CRM User Guide
- Contract Templates
- Customer Onboarding SOP

8. Revision History

| Version | Date        | Description     | Author        |
|---------|-------------|-----------------|---------------|
| 1.0     | 22-Jul-2026 | Initial release | Sales Manager |